

Survey response	
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Is your country a State Party to the Convention?	Yes
Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?	
Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:	
- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:	
- Please explain why:	
Is the Convention directly applicable in your country 's domestic law ?	
Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education [1]? [1] Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.	
Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked ?	
- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence. Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with the respect to the right to education.	
Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the	

Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:	
- If yes, please provide reference:	Australia's system was originally designed prior to the SDGs but is designed to align with the aims of SDG 4.
1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Legal texts (Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.) prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education]	Yes
1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education]	No

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum]	No
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]	Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In primary education]	Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In secondary education]	Yes
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In technical and vocational education and training]	No
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In higher education]	No
Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In adult education and alternative learning]	No
- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:	SDG Target 4.1, referred to in this question in relation to the equal access to education says: “By

	2030, ensure that all girls and boys complete free, equitable and quality primary and secondary education leading to relevant and effective learning outcomes.” Responsibility for school funding in Australia is shared. State and territory governments provide most of the public funding for government schools, which they own and operate. The Australian Government provides most of the public funding for non government schools. Australian Government funding for all schools contributes to inclusion in education for all. Australian Government recurrent funding for schools is calculated based on the Schooling Resource Standard (SRS), which is a needs-based mechanism prescribed in the Australian Education Act 2013 for the calculation and distribution of Australian Government funding for schools. A school’s total SRS includes a base amount for each primary and secondary student and up to 6 additional funding loadings for priority equity cohorts and disadvantaged schools. In 2024, the Australian Government funds at least 20% of each government’s school SRS and 80% of each non government school’s SRS. Students attending government schools are not required to pay tuition fees. However, parent contributions for certain non-tuition expenses such as materials, excursions and extra curricula activities are compulsory in some states and territories. In jurisdictions with compulsory contributions, financial assistance for parents unable to afford payment is available. Non-government schools set compulsory fees in consultation with their school community. Because its funding is based on enrolments in each sector, the students of all parents wishing to access school education where a compulsory tuition fee is not charged will attract Australian Government funding. The Australian Government delivers a range of supports to help families access the Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) they need through various Family Assistance Law, however, participation in ECEC is a voluntary decision of the parents or primary care-givers of the child. In the year before fulltime compulsory schooling begins, the Preschool Reform Agreement (PRA) between the Australian Government and all state and territory governments is in force. The objective of the PRA is to facilitate children’s early learning and development and transition to school by: • maintaining universal access to
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	affordable, • quality preschool programs for all children, • improving participation in preschool programs, • maximising the benefit of the preschool year by improving outcomes for children. There is no Commonwealth legislation explicitly enshrining the right to pre-primary education, and school attendance is not compulsory for children below the age of six.
- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:	The Australian Government has multiple policies and programs to support universal access to education. One key example is through the Community Child Care Fund (CCCF) Program, which supports eligible ECEC services to address barriers to participation in early childhood education and care in disadvantaged, regional and remote communities. In addition, the In Home Care (IHC) Program provides access to government subsidised ECEC in the family home and is targeted to assist parents or carers who are unable to access other approved ECEC options such as those who work non standard hours, are geographically isolated or families with challenging and complex needs. The Inclusion Support Program supports to eligible ECEC services to build their capacity and capability to include children with additional needs, so all children have genuine opportunities to access, participate and achieve positive learning outcomes. The program plays a vital role in ensuring children with additional needs, challenging and trauma related behaviours and serious medical or health conditions (including mental health) are included in ECEC services alongside their typically developing peers. The Australian Government also commissioned the Productivity Commission (PC) - the Government's principal review and advisory body on policies affecting the welfare of Australians—to undertake a comprehensive review of Australia's ECEC system. The PC final's report, released on 18 September 2024, is a significant input into the Government's work to chart the course to a universal ECEC system. The report considers how to build a high-quality early learning system that is affordable, accessible and inclusive, and is currently being considered by Government.
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In pre-	N/A

primary education (including early learning and care)]	
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In primary education]	N/A
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In secondary education]	N/A
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In technical and vocational education and training]	N/A
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In higher education]	N/A
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In adult education and alternative learning]	N/A
- Please provide details:	
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]	N/A
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In primary education]	N/A
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In secondary education]	N/A
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In technical and vocational education and training]	N/A
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In higher education]	N/A
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In adult education and alternative learning]	N/A
- Please provide details:	
Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:	The Australian Children's Education and Care Quality Authority (ACECQA) was established as an independent national authority under the Education and Care Services National Law Act 2010. ACECQA supports governments in administering the National Quality Framework (NQF) for ECEC. The NQF was first introduced in

	2012, and now has two national approved learning frameworks in operation under the NQF. ECEC relevant guidance (for children aged 0 – 5 years) is found in the Belonging, Being and Becoming: The Early Years Learning Framework for Australia (EYLF) v2.0 2022. The EYLF guides curriculum decision-making and assessment to promote children’s learning and draws on robust Australian and international evidence that confirms early childhood is a vital period in children’s continuing learning, development and wellbeing. The EYLF states that approved providers and educators have inclusion obligations under the Disability Discrimination Act and the Racial Discrimination Act and make reasonable adjustments for all Learning Outcomes to ensure learning engagement for all children. When educators respect the diversity of families and communities, and the aspirations they hold for their children, they can foster children’s motivation to learn and reinforce their sense of themselves as competent learners. They make curriculum decisions that uphold all children’s rights to have their cultures, identities, languages, capabilities and strengths acknowledged and valued and respond to the complexity of children’s and families’ lives.
1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Legislation provides for inclusive education for all]	No
1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all]	Yes
1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality	Yes

of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Teachers are trained on inclusive education and to value diversity]	
1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance]	Yes
1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided for]	Yes
1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design]	Yes
1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multilingual and intercultural education is supported]	Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Other]	
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:	The Australian Government is committed to ensuring all students have equitable access to high quality education to help them reach their educational potential. There are unique challenges for those identified as priority equity cohorts such as those living in regional, rural and remote areas. In addition to state and territory led initiatives, the Australian Government accesses evidence to inform policy decisions and targets resources and interventions to ensure equitable access to education for all students. The EYLF encourages educators to respect the diversity of families and communities, and the aspirations they hold for their children, so they can foster children's motivation to learn and reinforce their sense of themselves as competent learners. Teachers make curriculum decisions that uphold all children's rights to have their cultures, identities, languages, capabilities and strengths acknowledged and valued and respond to the complexity of children's and families' lives. An intensive early childhood education and care model trial is delivered across four sites. A dedicated First Nations site at Boori Milumba, aims to help disadvantaged children to bridge the gap to school readiness. It offers high quality, intensive early education and care, infant mental health and family support to redress harm and overcome trauma. The Boori Milumba model has systems in place to enact its Cultural Framework and embed culturally safe and responsive practices across the model for children, educators, families and carers. The leadership team at Boori Milumba uses a multi-disciplinary approach to enhance the integration of diverse professional knowledge and experiences in the provision of individualised education and care and cultural plans that are responsive to each child's abilities, strengths and interests. In line with the Accreditation Standards and Procedures for initial teacher education (ITE) in Australia, all ITE programs are required to include content by the

	end of 2025 on First Nations (Indigenous) peoples, cultures and perspectives; cultural responsiveness, including students who have English as an additional language/dialect (EAL/D); and diverse learning needs, including students with a disability. Focus area 4.1 of the Australian Professional Standards for Teachers requires all teachers to establish and implement inclusive and positive interactions to engage and support all students in classroom activities. Australian Government recurrent funding for schools is calculated based on the Schooling Resource Standard (SRS), which is a needs-based mechanism prescribed in the Australian Education Act 2013 for the calculation and distribution of Australian Government funding for schools. A school's total SRS includes a base amount for each primary and secondary student and up to 6 additional funding loadings for priority equity cohorts and disadvantaged schools. In 2024, the Australian Government funds at least 20% of each government's school SRS and 80% of each non-government school's SRS.
- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.	The PC's final report found that children who would benefit most from ECEC are less likely to attend. The PC identified this could be because services are unaffordable, difficult to access, or exclude some children with additional needs. The report highlights that Australia's current approach to inclusion primarily assists services to meet the needs of children with high needs, but provides insufficient support to meet broader inclusion needs. The report also found that current inclusion support funding is not distributed in line with developmental vulnerability. The report makes it clear that inclusion is a key pillar to universal ECEC, and that an inclusive ECEC system should enable all children to feel welcome at ECEC services that suit their needs, whether these arise from disability, developmental delay or their cultural background. The report offers several recommendations to support a more inclusive ECEC system for all children.
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Legislation provides for gender equality in education]	Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality]	No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken]	Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing positive or affirmative action measures]	No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing financial incentives and fellowships]	No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality]	Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]	Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education]	No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for]	No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities]	No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]	Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM)]	No
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET)]	Yes
Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Other]	

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:	Australia is party to the international human rights treaty, the Convention on the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination against Women. Relevant domestic legislation includes the Sex Discrimination Amendment Act 1995 (No. 165 of 1995) and the Sex Discrimination Act 1984 (No 4 of 1984). The former includes at Division 2 that “It is unlawful for an educational authority to discriminate against a student on the ground of the student's sex...: a. by denying the student access, or limiting the student's access, to any benefit provided by the educational authority; b. by expelling the student; or c. by subjecting the student to any other detriment.” Outcome 1 of the EYLF (Children develop knowledgeable confident self-identities, and a positive sense of self-worth) encourages educators to promote confident self-identities by providing books and other resources that depict diverse gender roles and identities respectfully. Outcome 2 of the EYLF (Children are connected with and contribute to their world) provides guidance for ECEC educators to “provide materials, texts and resources that are inclusive of gender, ability, ethnicity, culture, language and family diversity”. On 6 September 2022, the Hon. Ed Husic MP, Minister for Industry and Science, announced the Diversity in STEM Review. The review evaluated the impact of the existing suite of Women in STEM programs and other relevant measures in the Industry and Science portfolio. It also examined how these existing investments can be reformed and expanded to support greater diversity in Australia’s STEM sector. The Australian Government also funds STEM initiatives from the early years through to higher education that aim to improve student engagement and increase the number of STEM-qualified women in the labour force.
What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.	
Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) [1]: Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child’s right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are	Yes

not in school are more likely to get married. [1] Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: “a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition.”	
- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:	
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report ‘The right to education of minorities: Overview of States’ measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report ‘The right to education of minorities: Overview of States’ measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report ‘The	Yes

right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]	
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview	Yes

of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities]	
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]	Yes
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]	Yes
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Native language	No

instruction is ensured for national minorities]	
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]	No
National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Other]	
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:	One of the Principles of the EYLF is Respect for Diversity. This principle acknowledges that “Children are born belonging to a culture, which is not only influenced by traditional practices, heritage and ancestral knowledge, but also by the experiences, values and beliefs of individual families and communities. Respecting diversity means valuing and reflecting the practices, values and beliefs of families within the curriculum. Educators acknowledge the histories, cultures, languages, traditions, religions, spiritual beliefs, child rearing practices and lifestyle choices of families. They build culturally safe and secure environments for all children and their families.”

	The further principles of Cultural Responsiveness outlines that “educators who are culturally responsive respect multiple cultural ways of knowing, doing and being and celebrate the benefits of diversity. They honour differences and take action in the face of unfairness or discrimination.” Culturally responsive educators are: • knowledgeable of each child and family’s context • active in embedding Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander perspectives in all aspects of the curriculum • implementing anti-bias approaches, including social justice approaches to address racism/bias in the setting/community • embedding democratic and fair practices in their setting, including the importance of being a responsible citizen • supporting children to take culturally responsive actions in the face of unfairness/discrimination • collaborating with colleagues, children, families and their communities to build culturally safe learning spaces. The Commonwealth Teaching Scholarships (CTS) Program, aimed at attracting more high achieving and diverse candidates to the teaching professions, has a number of target cohorts including First Nations peoples and people from English as a second language and/or dialect. In line with the ITE, all ITE programs are required to include content by the end of 2025 on First Nations (Indigenous) peoples, cultures and perspectives; cultural responsiveness including students who have English as an additional language/dialect, and diverse learning needs, including students with a disability.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.	As part of extensive consultation for Australia’s Early Years Strategy 2024 – 2034, culturally and linguistically diverse families noted specific barriers that made it harder to understand, navigate, and receive ECEC services. This included barriers such as language and culture, legal status, impacts of trauma and a distrust of institutions often arising from experiences of, or fear of, child removal.
Indigenous people: [Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people]	No
Indigenous people: [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people]	Yes

Indigenous people: [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]	Yes
Indigenous people: [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people]	No
Indigenous people: [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people]	No
Indigenous people: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people]	No
Indigenous people: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people]	Yes
Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]	Yes
Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]	Yes
Indigenous people: [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]	Yes
Indigenous people: [Native language instruction is ensured]	Yes
Indigenous people: [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people]	Yes
Indigenous people: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]	Yes
Indigenous people: [Other]	
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:	The Objectives and Guiding principles of the Education and Care Services National Law Act 2010 outline specific requirements of the national education and care services quality framework. It is specified that “Australia's Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultures are valued”. Outcome 1 (Children have a strong sense of identity) of the EYLF recognises that “for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children, awareness of their kinship networks and connections to Country are important to development of identity”. Educators are encouraged to be culturally responsive in assisting all children to explore their cultural, social, gender and linguistic identities. The Community Child Care Fund Restricted (CCCFR) grant program currently supports 149 ECEC services across Australia. CCCFR funding aims to ensure the continuity of specified ECEC services in disadvantaged and vulnerable communities

	(mostly in regional, remote and very remote areas). CCCFR funding also supports capacity building and sustainable child care ECEC service operations to increase early childhood education and care participation by First Nations children. CCCFR funded services are a mix of Centre Based Day Care (CBDC), mobile services, Out of School Hours Care (OSHC), vacation care and occasional care service types. The CCCFR Expansion grant program currently supports eight First Nations-led organisations in remote and very remote Australia. The program funds new, high-quality ECEC services in remote areas with low or no supply of childcare subsidy approved ECEC. It is a Closing the Gap measure and will help services address community level barriers to ECEC participation and increase the number of First Nations children accessing quality ECEC. Connected Beginnings aims to help First Nations children aged zero to five to become school ready. Connected Beginnings draws upon the strength and knowledge of First Nations communities to increase children's and families' engagement with health and early childhood education and care. It improves access to existing early childhood, maternal and child health, and family support services so children are safe, healthy and ready to thrive at school by the age of five. The program was established in 2016 and works closely with First Nations communities to identify early childhood priorities for change, and to lift participation in quality and culturally appropriate early childhood services and programs to improve school readiness and developmental outcomes for children. The Commonwealth is committed to ensuring Aboriginal Community Controlled Organisations (ACCOs) lead and manage projects wherever possible. The program has been announced in 48 communities across Australia including metropolitan, regional, remote and very remote locations, and is expanding to 50 sites by 2024-25. Professional learning for existing teachers is primarily the responsibility of state and territory governments and non-government education authorities.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.	In 2021, the Australian Government in partnership with SNAICC – National Voice for our Children, the peak body representing the interests of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander children and families, delivered the National Aboriginal and

	Torres Strait Islander Early Childhood Strategy (NATSIECS). Extensive consultation for the NATSIECS outlined specific challenges for First Nations children and families, including a lack of culturally appropriate information and support services, and challenges for families to navigate complex service systems. In later years, consultation with First Nations children and families for development of the Early Years Strategy echoed these concerns, and further stressed the importance of access to material basics like housing, food, clean drinking water and transport, to achieve the vision for the Strategy.
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Legislation provides for their right to education]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]	No

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [All administrative barriers to access education are removed]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers are provided for]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers	Yes

are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion]	
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]	Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for]	Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Auxiliary assistance is provided]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided]	No

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Accelerated learning programmes are provided]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Language classes to newcomers are provided for]	No
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped	No

populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged]	
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Other]	
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:	The Government provides early childhood education and care fee assistance for families through the Child Care Subsidy. As with most other Government payments, to receive Child Care Subsidy families must meet the residence rules. These rules are designed to assist as many families as possible within the Government’s financial limitations. The residency rules require an individual or their partner to be living in Australia and have one of the following: Australian citizenship, a permanent visa, Special Category visa, or certain temporary visa types, for example a Partner Provisional or Temporary Protection visa. Most temporary residents do not meet the residence rules and are not eligible for Child Care Subsidy. Exemptions exist for situations where hardship would be caused if an individual was not treated as a resident, or where special circumstances exist. Each case is assessed based on individual circumstances and is a discretionary decision. People living in Australia with a permanent humanitarian visa are eligible to apply for a CTS.
- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?	No
- Please elaborate	
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed,	

brief quantitative information may be added.	
People with disabilities: [Legislation provides for their right to education]	Yes
People with disabilities: [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]	No
People with disabilities: [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]	Yes
People with disabilities: [Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools]	No
People with disabilities: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided]	No
People with disabilities: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided]	No
People with disabilities: [Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities]	No
People with disabilities: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]	Yes
People with disabilities: [Auxiliary assistance is provided]	No
People with disabilities: [Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted]	Yes
People with disabilities: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]	Yes
People with disabilities: [Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted]	Yes
People with disabilities: [Other]	
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:	The Disability Standards for Education 2005 clarify the obligations of education and training providers under the Disability Discrimination Act 1992. The Disability Standard for Education are reviewed every 5 years to find out how they could be improved, and the next review will be in 2025. In addition, Australia's Disability Strategy 2021–2031 calls on all Australians to ensure people with disability can participate as equal members of society. Policy Priority 1 of this strategy is to ensure children with disability can access and participate in high-quality early childhood education and care. The learning outcomes of the EYLF ensure that “approved providers and educators have inclusion obligations under the Disability Discrimination Act... and make

	reasonable adjustments for all Learning Outcomes to ensure learning engagement for all children.” A reasonable adjustment is defined in the EYLF as “a measure or action taken by approved providers and educators to assist children with disability to participate in education and care on the same basis as children without disability. An adjustment is reasonable if it achieves this purpose while balancing the interests of all parties affected, including the child with disability, the approved provider, educators and other children.” ECEC services can access the Inclusion Development Fund (IDF) to address barriers to inclusion through the Inclusion Support Program (ISP). IDF provides a subsidy for an Additional Educator and Innovative Solutions project funding for innovative, flexible and responsive solutions to inclusion where barriers have been identified and cannot be addressed by the support provided by the Inclusion Agency.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.	
Students from poor households: [Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided]	Yes
Students from poor households: [Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education]	No
Students from poor households: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided]	Yes
Students from poor households: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]	Yes
Students from poor households: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]	Yes
Students from poor households: [Other]	
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:	Australian families receive help with the cost of child care through the Government’s Child Care Subsidy (CCS). CCS is paid directly to approved providers and passed on to families as a fee reduction. The Australian Government subsidises the cost of child care, while state and territory governments are responsible for the health, safety, wellbeing and educational outcomes of children. There are various eligibility requirements that

	scale the amount of funding available for each child based on relevant factors, including income-levels. In 2024-25 financial year, families with an annual income up to \$83,280 AUD are eligible for a 90 per cent subsidy rate, with this amount tapering off for income levels above this. The level of support under the CCS remains proportional to family income, and Higher CCS for families with multiple children aged five or under in care remains targeted at families with a combined income under \$365,611 AUD from July 2024. An Additional Child Care Subsidy (ACCS) (temporary financial hardship) is offered to provide short-term support to families who are experiencing significant financial stress due to exceptional circumstances beyond their control. To be eligible for this subsidy, the individual must be eligible for Child Care Subsidy, have experienced temporary financial hardship due to an event that occurred in the last 6 months, and have a substantially reduced ability to pay early childhood education and care fees. The Preschool Reform Agreement provides funding to states and territories to deliver quality, affordable preschool programs which: • meet the needs of children, parents, and communities, • improve preschool outcomes for all children, and • are provided at a cost which does not present a barrier to participation, particularly for disadvantaged children.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.	The PC's final report highlights affordability is a substantial barrier to ECEC access for many families, especially those experiencing disadvantage. The report found that ECEC is less affordable for lower-income families. It also noted that financial resources are more constrained for lower-income families, which makes them more sensitive to price - likely contributing to their lower participation rates in ECEC.
2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized "the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth"	No

(General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free]	
2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human	Yes

development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable]	
2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis]	Yes
2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became	Yes

more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play.]	
- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:	As part of the October 2022-23 Budget, the Australian Government invested \$4.6 billion AUD to increase Child Care Subsidy (CCS) rates for families earning less than \$530,000. This figure was indexed to \$533,280 in July 2024. These changes that came into effect in July 2023 helped to ease cost-of-living pressures for around 1.2 million families using ECEC, improve educational outcomes for children, and support parents and carers, particularly women, to increase their workforce participation if they choose to.
Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is compulsory.]	No
Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not compulsory.]	Yes
Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is free of charge for all.]	No
Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not free.]	Yes

- Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:	
- Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:	
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.	The Australian Government provides funding to support state and territory delivery of preschool through the Preschool Reform Agreement (PRA). Through the PRA, the Australian Government is making up to \$2 billion AUD available to support preschool programs from 2022 to 2025. This funding benefits around 320,000 children across 13 100 services each year. This funding ensures every child can participate in 15 hours of quality preschool a week where 'cost is not a barrier' in the year before full time school. Preschool in Australia is generally delivered either in a dedicated preschool setting, or in a Centre-based Day Care (CBDC) setting. Dedicated preschools are usually part of a school or community-run and are generally free. Where preschool is delivered in a CBDC setting, the Australian Government operates a subsidy-based ECEC system, with various eligibility requirements that scale the amount of funding available for each child based on relevant factors, including income-levels. In the 2024-25 financial year, families with an annual income up to \$83,280 AUD are eligible for a 90 per cent subsidy rate, with this amount tapering off for income levels above this. The level of support under the CCS remains proportional to family income, and Higher CCS for families with multiple children aged five or under in care remains targeted at families with a combined income under \$365,611 from July 2024. Many states and territories offer additional fee relief on top of the CCS system for preschool. The Australian Government does not collect data on indirect costs. CBDC settings usually provide meals and consumables (such as art supplies) and do not require a uniform. Dedicated preschools usually supply consumables and require families to supply food for their children.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Limited access]	Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor quality programmes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor learning outcomes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]	Yes
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Lack of support to families]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	The PC's final report identified various barriers to accessing ECEC, including issues related to availability, affordability, inclusion, and practical challenges. The report also emphasises the importance of addressing workforce challenges in the sector as a crucial step towards achieving a universal ECEC system. Attracting, developing, and retaining staff is a significant challenge currently impacting the ECEC sector, with workforce issues often impacting providers ability to operate in particular areas The Australian Government recognises ongoing pressures on the ECEC workforce, exacerbated by the COVID-19 pandemic, which impact the availability of ECEC services. On 3 May 2023, the Government announced a \$72.4 million package over 5 years to support the skills and training of workers in the ECEC sector. In recognition of workforce challenges, the Australian Government has implemented the following actions under the Australian Children's Education and Care Quality Authority (ACECQA)'s National Children's Education and Care Workforce Strategy: • development of new resources to enhance

	promotion of the career opportunities in Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) through the Australian Government Jobs Hub website and the National Careers Institute; • establishment of Jobs and Skills Councils to reform the industry engagement arrangements in the Vocational Education and Training (VET) system; • funding ACECQA's development of an 'induction to the National Quality Framework' to improve access to core professional development for early childhood educators and teachers. • funding the delivery of Beyond Blue's national mental health and wellbeing initiative for ECEC services and schools, Be You, until 2027. • commissioned the review of targeted programs that support studies and placements of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander educators and teachers, and educators and teachers in regional, rural and remote areas, to inform the development of new targeted programs. • funding the delivery of the 2024 National Workforce Census to ensure fit for purpose data is available on the early childhood workforce. The Australian Government commissioned the Jobs and Skills Council to undertake a capacity study of the ECEC workforce, with a final report released on 3 September 2024. The report found that there is a current shortfall of over 21,000 ECEC professionals to meet existing demand and support more sustainable working conditions. The findings and recommendations will be considered alongside the PC Inquiry into ECEC final report to support Government policy planning for ECEC workforce support.
2.2 Primary and secondary education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide "12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory." Primary education - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:	
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is compulsory]	Yes

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not compulsory.]	No
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is free of charge.]	Yes
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not free.]	No
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.	Under Australia's constitutional agreements, state and territory governments are responsible for providing school education. This includes the registration and regulation of all schools in their jurisdiction (government and non-government schools) and the operation of public schools. The Commonwealth does not run any schools, nor does it employ any teachers. It does, however, provide significant funding for schools and is involved in setting national education policies. The school starting age ranges from 4.5 years to 6.5 years across jurisdictions. Government schools provide free primary education in each jurisdiction.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Limited access]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [High dropout rates]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor quality programmes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in foundation literacy]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in numeracy]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in social and emotional learning]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Other poor learning outcomes]	No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Disparity in learning outcomes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]	No
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	
Secondary education In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training. - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:	Secondary schooling in Australia comprises years 7 to 12 across all jurisdictions and is not generally divided into lower and upper secondary education. There is no compulsory secondary school enrolment age although there is a minimum school leaving age, which is 17 across all jurisdictions except WA (17 years 6 months or 18 years, depending on certain criteria) and Tas (17 to 18 years, depending on certain criteria).
- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:	Australia does not separate upper and lower secondary education.
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is compulsory.]	Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not compulsory.]	No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is free of charge.]	No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not free of charge.]	Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is compulsory.]	No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not compulsory.]	No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is free of charge]	No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not free of charge.]	Yes
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and	Secondary education costs are determined by individual schools, and can include fees, voluntary financial contributions, extra-curricular items and

tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.	activities, uniforms and costs related to digital devices.
- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education: For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.	No
- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:	The minimum age for employment depends on the state and territory a person is working on. For example, there is no minimum working age in South Australia or New South Wales, whereas in Queensland the minimum age is generally 13. Jurisdictions generally have additional regulation for school-aged workers to ensure school requirements are not impacted. State and territory governments are responsible for enforcing applicable working age requirements.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Limited access]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [High dropout rates]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor quality programmes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor learning outcomes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low readiness of primary graduates]	No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	
2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is free of charge]	No
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basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships]	
2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures]	No

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states]	Yes
2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free	Yes

education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).]	
2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical,	

vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Other]	
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.	Credit and recognition of prior learning arrangements under the Australian Qualifications Framework (AQF) support students to flexibly receive credit for prior studies, including through non-formal and informal education where appropriate. The AQF Qualifications Pathways Policy provides guidance for providers to ensure credit recognition processes are clear, transparent, flexible, and systematic. The policy is supported by additional explanatory documents covering articulation, recognition of prior learning, and credit transfer. These guidelines aim to facilitate easier entry and eliminate barriers for students in accessing AQF qualifications. Australia's higher education system allows for flexible learning pathways and entry into tertiary education for students. For example, the Australian Government provides funding for higher education enabling programs to help prospective higher education students with insufficient academic preparation to gain the skills and knowledge required to enrol in a higher education course of study. Depending on the particular needs of students, enabling programs vary significantly in their form, entry requirements, content, mode of delivery and course length to help students meet academic requirements. A new short 6-month qualification type called the Undergraduate Certificate was also introduced in recent years to help people to upskill and reskill, which includes built in credit that can be used towards longer form sub-bachelor or bachelor qualifications. The Australian Government also has a program to pilot the design and delivery of higher education microcredentials, which also provide credit towards a formal higher education qualification. The Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021 sets out the requirements that a higher education provider must meet – and continue to meet – to be registered by the national higher education regulator, the Tertiary Education Quality and Standards Agency (TEQSA). To operate in Australia a higher education provider must be

	registered by TEQSA under the Tertiary Education and Quality Standards Agency Act 2011. The Threshold Standards hold that higher education providers comply with all applicable laws and regulations which includes Commonwealth and State and Territory anti-discrimination legislation. All higher education providers set their own fees and charges related to course enrolments. Providers must also published the course entry requirements for each course which is assessed on the basis of the applicants individual capacity . Relevant Threshold Standards Admission: Standard 1.1.1 requires that admissions policies, requirements and procedures are documented, are applied fairly and consistently, and are designed to ensure that admitted students have the academic preparation and proficiency in English needed to participate in their intended study, and no known limitations that would be expected to impede their progression and completion. Credit and recognition of prior learning: Standard 1.2 requires that as part of the admissions process, students are informed of their rights and obligations, including policies, arrangements and potential eligibility for credit for prior learning. It also requires that providers consistently apply the AQF Qualifications Pathways Policy to credit and recognition of prior learning (RPL) in their policies and process so that student progression is enhanced into and between qualifications, and to recognise the multiple pathways that students take to gain qualifications, and that learning can be formal, non-formal or informal. Standard 1.1.2 also requires that admissions process ensures that, prior to enrolment and before fees are accepted, students are informed of their rights and obligations, including that policies, arrangements and potential eligibility for credit for prior learning. Accessibility through Affirmative action: Standard 2.2 requires that higher education providers have institutional policies, practices and approaches to teaching and learning are designed to accommodate student diversity, including the under-representation and/or disadvantage experienced by identified groups, and create equivalent opportunities for academic success regardless of students' backgrounds. Specific consideration is given to the recruitment, admission, participation and completion of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples.
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	Pathways: Pathways into and between qualifications are provided for in institutional credit and RPL policies, as set out in Standard 1.2 and the AQF Qualifications Pathways Policy. Course Design: All providers are required to design each course of study with specified information that includes entry requirements and pathways including exit pathways, articulation arrangements and pathways to further learning. Fees and Charges: As part of the admissions process Standard 1.1.2 requires that, prior to enrolment and before fees are accepted, students are informed of their rights and obligations, including that all charges associated with their proposed studies as known at the time and advice on the potential for changes in charges during their studies and policies on changes to or withdrawal from offers, acceptance and enrolment, tuition protection and refunds of charges. Information about fees and charges for prospective and current students is also specified in 7.2. Providers must give students reasonable notice of changes about increases in fees and associated costs and any consequences that may affect their choice of, or ability to participate in, an intended course(s) of study.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Limited access]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor quality programmes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor learning outcomes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Low number of professionally trained professors]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education]	No
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items	No

may be ticked): [Provision of literacy programmes]	
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)]	Yes
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures	No

taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge learning opportunities]	
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes]	Yes
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work	Yes

and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning]	
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling]	No
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge,	No

skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.]	
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Other]	
- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:	
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited access]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor quality programmes]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited funding]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor learning outcomes]	No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [State monitoring and inspections]	Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Health and sanitation]	Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))]	Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Infrastructure]	Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Curriculum]	Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory	No

framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Student-teacher ratio]	
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [School fees (if relevant)]	No
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Other]	
- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:	In Australia, all approved ECEC services are assessed by their state or territory regulatory authority and receive a quality rating. Services are assessed against the 7 quality areas of the National Quality Standard to promote continuous improvement and help families make informed decisions about their child's education and care. Assessments are undertaken by the state or territory regulatory authority and services are given a rating for each of the quality areas. They are assessed on their program and practice, health and safety, physical environment, staffing, relationships with children, governance and leadership. They are also assessed on their collaborative relationships with families and their local communities. Services are given overall rating based on the ratings for each of the quality areas and ratings must be displayed at the service. The quality ratings are published on ACECQAs national registers and are available on the Starting Blocks website. Preschools delivered as part of public schools are governed by state and territory-based school standards. The Australian Curriculum (Curriculum) Version 9.0 was approved on 1 April 2022. The Curriculum sets the expectations for what all Australian students should be taught regardless of where they live, or their background. It is developed and administered by the Australian Curriculum, Assessment and Reporting Authority (ACARA). The Curriculum includes eight learning areas, seven general capabilities and three cross

	curriculum priorities. It is designed to help all young Australians to become successful learners, confident and creative individuals, and active and informed citizens.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Violence in schools]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Cost of education]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Conflicts or crises]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Inadequate parental support to education]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Long distances to schools]	No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	Historically it has been identified that there had been some instances of refusal of admission to Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) services for children with known disabilities (known as ‘gatekeeping’). Discriminatory admissions practices not only have direct impacts on the quality of a child’s education and care but can have downstream impacts on the parents’ and carers’ employment or business opportunities. The Department of Education is providing input into the Disability Standards for Education Amendment Standards 2024 in order to clarify good practice for the inclusion of children with disability in an ECEC setting. On 1 October 2023, to reflect the National Approved Learning Frameworks (V2.0), the Australian Children’s Education and Care Quality Authority (ACECQA) updated the Guide to the National Quality Framework (NQF) to further embed inclusive practice of children with disability and enhance the

	support provided to educators by clarifying obligations already in place under the NQF (including where these correlate to existing obligations under the DDA).
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teacher training is provided without discrimination.]	Yes
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teachers’ average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).]	No
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching	Yes

and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.]	
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.]	Yes
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.]	Yes
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the	No

measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.]	
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Establishment of performance monitoring systems.]	No
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.]	No
3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to	

“substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Other]	
- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:	Australia recognises that the quality of the children’s education and care workforce is critical to the success of the NQF. Higher qualifications are strongly associated with improved child outcomes as appropriately qualified educators and teachers are better able to involve children, stimulate positive interactions, and use a range of strategies to extend and support learning and development. Supporting the workforce to provide high quality ECEC is a priority for the Government. Central to this is the need to ensure ECEC educators are valued as professionals and fairly remunerated for the critical work they do. The Australian Government recently announced a historic 2-year, 15 per cent wage increase for ECEC workers. This wage increase will be tied to a commitment from ECEC centres to limit fee increases to 4.4 per cent over the next 12 months from 8 August 2024, with a new indexation to be developed by the Australian Bureau of Statistics to apply the year after. This is an important condition that will keep downward pressure on fees for families. In 2024 the Australian Government announced \$72.4 million over 5 years to support the Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) sector to build and retain the ECEC workforce. The National Teacher Workforce Action Plan (NTWAP) was agreed by Australian Education Ministers in on 15 December 2022 to increase the number of people choosing to become teachers and to keep the teachers we have. The Australian Government is investing more than \$337 million to implement initiatives in the NTWAP in five priority areas: improving teacher supply; strengthening initial teacher education; keeping the teachers we have; elevating the profession; and better understanding future teacher workforce needs. In 2022, the Australian Government established the Teacher Education Expert Panel (TEEP) to improve initial teacher education (ITE) to boost graduation rates and ensure graduating teachers are better prepared for the classroom.

	Australian Government supports alternative pathways into teaching through the High Achieving Teachers (HAT) Program. Alternative pathways into teaching broaden the entry points into the teaching profession by allowing individuals to work while they complete their teaching qualification. Alternative pathways assist employers of teachers by recruiting participants with the skills, experience, and personal characteristics that schools need.
- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Shortages of teaching staff]	Yes
- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff]	No
- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of training centres]	No
- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]	Yes
- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [High student – teacher ratio]	No
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	ACECQA's ECEC Workforce Strategy 2021 Shaping our Future found that many service providers reported that some vocationally trained educators can lack fundamental skills and knowledge, and may not have realistic expectations about working in children's education and care. Further, inappropriately short duration qualifications, variable Registered Training Organisation (RTO) quality and insufficient knowledge of the NQF were the most commonly cited reasons for poor quality graduates. Currently, there are challenges in attracting new teachers, retaining teachers and difficulty ensuring there are enough experienced or specialised teachers. In July 2023, the Teacher Education Expert Panel (TEEP) noted that many beginning teachers have reported that they felt they needed to be better equipped for the challenges they faced in the classroom when starting their teaching careers. It was observed that nearly four in 10 ITE students leave their course within six years of commencing their degree and around one in five beginning

	teachers leaves within the first three years of entering the teaching profession.
3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Curriculum includes human rights education.]	Yes
3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974	Yes

Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.]	
3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and	

fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Other]	
- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:	ECEC offers an environment for children to learn about their rights and responsibilities and to develop an awareness and respect for others. In Australia, articles from the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child are embedded within the objectives and principles of Australia’s National Quality Framework and our Approved Learning Frameworks. Educators are encouraged to consider the rights of the child, and to support children to build relationships with each other based on care, empathy and respect. The Australian Human Rights Commission worked closely with Australia’s ECEC sector to develop ‘Building and Belonging’ – a toolkit for early childhood educators to support handling of issues and questions around racial differences and cultural diversity. Under the ITE, as part of initial teacher education, it is a requirement that to teach legislation, regulations, policies and obligations related to inclusion and support including international agreements (e.g. the UN Convention on Children’s Rights 1989) and legal entitlements as defined by the Commonwealth Disability Discrimination Act 1992 and core education policy such as the Disability Standards for Education 2005. Focus area 4.1 of the Australian Professional Standards for Teachers requires all teachers to establish and implement inclusive and positive interactions to engage and support all students in classroom activities.
3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education	No

(several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:]	
3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:][Comment]	
3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:]	No
3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to	

guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:][Comment]	
3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:]	No
3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:][Comment]	
3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:]	Yes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:][Comment]	
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Registration]	Yes
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [State monitoring and inspections]	Yes
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Qualifications of teachers]	Yes
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Health and sanitation]	Yes
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related	Yes

gender-based violence (in and around schools)]	
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Infrastructure]	Yes
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Curriculum]	Yes
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Student-teacher ratio]	Yes
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School fees]	No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School closures]	No
Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Other]	
- Please elaborate:	The registration of early childhood teachers by state and territory teacher regulatory authorities formally recognises their work as part of the broader teaching profession. All state and territory jurisdictions register early childhood teachers where they meet their registration requirements. State and territory regulatory authorities' processes consider a teacher's qualifications to determine the educational setting where they can teach. The Australian Children's Education and Care Quality Authority (ACECQA) was established as an

	independent national authority under the Education and Care Services National Law Act 2010. ACECQA supports governments in administering the National Quality Framework (NQF) for ECEC. The NQF was first introduced in 2012, and now has two national approved learning frameworks in operation under the NQF. ECEC relevant guidance (for children aged 0 – 5 years) is found in the Belonging, Being and Becoming: The Early Years Learning Framework for Australia (EYLF). In Australia, all approved ECEC services are assessed by their state or territory regulatory authority and receive a quality rating. Services are assessed against the 7 quality areas of the National Quality Standard to promote continuous improvement and help families make informed decisions about their child's education and care. Assessments are undertaken by the state or territory regulatory authority and services are given a rating for each of the quality areas. They are assessed on their program and practice, health and safety, physical environment, staffing, relationships with children, governance and leadership. They are also assessed on their collaborative relationships with families and their local communities. . Services are given overall rating based on the ratings for each of the quality areas, ratings must be displayed at the service. The quality ratings are published on ACECQAs national registers and are available on the Starting Blocks website.
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]	No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]	Yes
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [High student – teacher ratio]	No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Issues in terms of equity and inclusion]	No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity]	No

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	See above response regarding workforce and training at question in Section 3 - Education personnel.
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.]	No
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)]	Yes
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital	No

environment. [Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.]	
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content , including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.]	No
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.]	No
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital	Yes

education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education]	
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.]	No
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.]	No
- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:	On 1 July, ACECQA released the National Model Code – Taking images of children in early childhood education and care (National Model

	Code) which promote a child safe culture when it comes to taking, sharing and storing images or videos of children in early childhood education and care. ACECQA, working with all governments and relevant experts, are currently developing additional guidance to support all NQF approved providers, service leaders and educators with practical advice and tips on creating and maintaining a safe online environments in children's education and care services. This guide will build on the National Model Code to provide information and links to resources on issues that all children's education and care providers and their services are navigating every day. This includes taking and sharing images or videos of children (and gaining assent and consent from children and families for this to occur); safe storage and retention of personal information, including cyber security considerations; the use of CCTV; the use of AI; and the engagement and involvement of families and the community on these issues. Work will compliment advice provided by the Office of the eSafety Commissioner. This new guidance will address relevant issues raised through the Review of Child Safety Arrangements under the National Quality Framework, and is expected to be finalised and made available to the sector in the first half of 2025. Note the above are not currently a legislative requirement but future legislative change is being considered Educators know children engage with popular culture, media and digital technologies so they build partnerships with families and others to keep children safe and families aware of e-safety information. While the Australian Government provides strategic direction and national leadership of Australia's school education system, the delivery of school education is the responsibility of state and territory government and non-government education authorities. Safer Technologies for Schools (ST4S) has been developed to enhance the security, privacy, interoperability and online safety of software applications and services commonly used by Australian and New Zealand schools. The goals and standards of ST4S are shared by all Australian and New Zealand education jurisdictions – including state, territory, Catholic and independent school sectors – for the benefit of the whole education community,. The Australian
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	Government will continue to engage with state and territory government and non-government education authorities, share best practice and key learnings through ongoing participation in the National AI in Schools Taskforce. In February 2023, Education Ministers agreed that responding to the risks and harnessing opportunities for Australian schools and students arising from generative AI technologies is a national education priority and agreed to develop an evidence-informed, best practice framework for Australian schools: the Australian Framework for Generative Artificial Intelligence in Schools (the Framework). The use of AI in schools is being piloted across Australia through a range of initiatives funded by jurisdictions, or co-funded by the Australian Government. Where states and territories are funding their own GenAI pilots, they will continue to monitor and conduct their own evaluations and share their learnings through the National AI in Schools Taskforce. In addition, in the 2024-25 Budget the Australian Government announced funding under the Teacher Resource Hubs measure to continue the delivery of 6 existing initiatives that provide evidence-based curriculum and student wellbeing resources and professional development for teachers and school leaders. This includes the Literacy Hub and Year 1 Phonics Check; Digital Technologies Hub; Mathematics Hub, Massive Open Online Courses and Year 1 Number Check; Student Wellbeing Hub; Civics and Citizenship Hub; and the Early Learning Languages Australia initiative. These initiatives all provide freely available, curriculum-aligned digital content to support schools nationally. The Government is continuing to fund various digital measures, including the Digital Technologies Hub and the National Lending Library, to engage students and support the professional learning of teachers, as well as provide equipment to schools around Australia to support the teaching of digital technology, digital literacy, cyber security and emerging technologies, including AI. The Australian Government notes that there are a range of challenges with the provision of digital education and that these challenges can vary across the country. While the Australian Government provides strategic direction and national leadership of Australia's education system, the delivery of school education is the responsibility of state and
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	territory government and non-government education authorities.
Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework. - Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:	
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways]	No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions]	No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks]	Yes
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to internet and/or electricity]	No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.)]	No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions]	No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale]	No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice]	No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Disjointed or fragmented	No

solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated]	
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.]	Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring results are made public]	Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.]	No
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.]	No
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.]	No
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.]	No
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.]	Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public	Yes

authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	The Australian Government makes it easier for families to find information they need to make important choices about their children's care needs through the Starting Blocks website. Families can search for information on vacancies, service fees, inclusions and quality ratings on the one website. Upgrades to the website have been made so families have even greater information about the fees charged by providers, as well as revenue and profit information for large for-profit providers. By doing this, the Government has followed through on its commitment to improving transparency in the child care sector. Targeted programs such as CCCF, Connected Beginnings, In Home Care and the Inclusion Support Program referenced throughout this document demonstrate the Australian Government's commitment to allocate financial resources broadly to meet accessibility needs across Australia for different demographics. Governance arrangements under the CCCFR Expansion Program include the establishment of an Expert Advisory Group, predominantly composed of First Nations membership, to guide major decision-making. Additionally, SNAICC is the Community Partner for the program, working in partnership with the department to provide support to sites ensuring the program continues to align with the needs and perspectives of Indigenous communities through shared decision-making, promoting culturally responsive and effective service delivery.
Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:	https://www.startingblocks.gov.au/find-child-care
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Budgetary constraints]	No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels]	No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions]	No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Absence of	No

supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment]	
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data]	No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Other]	
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.	
- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages]	No
- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources]	No
- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments]	No

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Other]	
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